Marcelo S. O. Goncalves

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Education

Duke University *Durham, NC, USA*
PhD in Public Policy *Sept 2025 (expected)*
- Dissertation: Essays on the Political Economy of Sustainable Development

University of California, San Diego *San Diego, CA, USA*
Master of International Affairs *June 2018*
- Concentration: Public Policy and Development Economics
- Additional Certificates: Policy Design and Evaluation; Quantitative Analysis

University of Brasilia *Brasilia, Brazil*
MA Political Science *April 2007*
BA Political Science *March 2005*

National School of Public Administration *Brasilia, Brazil*
Specialization in Public Policy and Management *June 2006*

Skills and additional training

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (advanced), Spanish (Intermediate), French (beginner)
Statistical packages: STATA, R, Python
Geospatial and Remote Sensing Tools: ArcGIS, Quantum GIS, Google Earth Engine
Other tools: MS Office, LaTeX

Experience

Since 2006, I have served as a Specialist in Public Policy and Management within the Brazilian Federal Civil Service. In this capacity, I have held the following roles:

https://anesp.org.br/english

Senior Policy Advisor *Brasilia, Brazil*
Ministry of Social Development *Jan 2019-July 2021*
- Deputy Chief of Staff of the Secretariat of Evaluation and Information Management (SAGI).
- Collaborated in the design and execution of 32 research projects, including two randomized controlled trials (RCTs), to evaluate the effectiveness of federal programs.
- Drafted policy memoranda that shaped emergency economic relief policies, directly benefiting low-income households during the COVID-19 pandemic.
- Developed technical reports to optimize and enhance strategic federal programs, including the National Housing Program and the conditional cash transfer program (*Bolsa Família*), improving program reach and efficiency.

Joint-Secretary for Racial Equality *Brasilia, Brazil*
Ministry of Human Rights *Jun 2018-Jan 2019*
- Led a national secretariat overseeing two departments, two national councils, and two supporting units, managing a team of approximately 70 professionals to advance key policy initiatives.
- Oversaw the construction of 4,000 rainwater harvesting systems in ethnic communities (*Quilombos*) in drought-prone regions, enhancing climate resilience and water access.
- Managed the implementation of nearly 200 projects nationwide, focusing on the promotion of human rights and advancing racial equality.

Chief of Staff *Brasilia, Brazil*
National Council for Food Security *Aug 2014-Aug 2016*
- Led a 20-person team responsible for providing strategic advice to the Council and the Federal Government

on food security and social policy issues.

- Drafted technical reports that were instrumental in shaping national food security policies, including the National Policy for Adequate Access to Food (PNAA), the National School Feeding Program (PNAE), and smallholder development initiatives.
- Held a joint appointment as General Coordinator of Support for Local Agri-Food Public Systems (Ministry of Social Development), in charge of enhancing coordination between federal and local food security policies.

Policy Analysis Manager *Brasilia, Brazil*
Office of the Presidency of the Republic of Brazil *Dec 2012-Aug 2014*

- Directed the planning and execution of national surveys and qualitative assessments to evaluate citizens' perceptions of federal public policies. Some of the quantitative assessments were pioneering efforts, becoming the first of their kind to cover the entire country.

Advisor *Brasilia, Brazil*
National Council for Food Security and Ministry of Social Development *Feb 2009-Dec 2012*

- Drafted policy memoranda to support the Council's stance on key social programs implemented by the Brazilian government.
- Held a joint appointment as Technical Advisor to the Ministry of Social Development, advising on policies related to social welfare and development initiatives.

Project Planning Manager *Brasilia, Brasil*
Ministry of Labor and Employment *Feb 2008–Feb 2009*

- Led an 18-person team responsible for planning and executing the Ministry of Labor's qualification program for low-income, unemployed workers.
- Developed and implemented projects that benefited approximately 270,000 workers over a two-year period.

Advisor *Brasilia, Brasil*
Ministry of Labor and Employment *Jun 2006-Feb 2008*

- Implemented a budget management program that improved efficiency across the Ministry's 513 decentralized offices, transforming a 10% deficit into a 2% surplus.

Research Assistant *Brasilia, Brasil*
Diferencial Consultoria *May-Oct 2004*

- Researched and organized data on educational policy to support the elaboration of an educational reform in Brazil

Other projects

Research & Consulting

- Consultancy/Research Project (2025-2026): Social impact assessment of Forest Stewardship Council (FSC) certification in Brazil - *in progress*.
- Consultancy/Research Project (2022): Agri-Food Supply chains and Land Inequality (With Gabriela Nagle). Client: Oxfam International.

Volunteer Work:

- Co-founder of the projects Politeia and Politics at the School. Projects designed to promote civic values and educate young students about political participation and democratic institutions.

Publications

Peer-reviewed publications

- Book Bans in Political Context: Evidence from U.S. Public Schools (2024) *PNAS Nexus*. (with Isabelle Langrock, Jack LaViolette, & Katie Spoon)
- "Data-Driven Implementation: The Role of Information and Technology in Public Responses to Social Emergencies." *Pandemic, Lockdown, and Digital Transformation: Challenges and Opportunities for Public Administration, NGOs, and Businesses* (2021): 25-45. (With Bruno B. Cardoso)

Working Papers/ Work in Progress

- Building Climate-Resilience in the Global South: How a Decentralized Water Policy Alleviates the Conse-

quences of Climate Shocks in Brazil.

- Grassroots Guardians: How collective institutions Amplify Efforts Against Deforestation in Brazil. (With Mateo Villamizar-Chaparro & Subhrendu Pattanayak)
- Institutions, Incentives, and Identity in Land Use Decisions: A Micro-Level Analysis of Deforestation Drivers in the Global South (with Paula J. Sarmiento)
- Access to Water and Climate Change: Adaptation, Fertility Decisions and Birth Outcomes in the Brazilian Semiarid Region. (with Marcos Rangel)
- The Political Logic of Persistent Deforestation: Electoral Incentives and Public Goods in the Brazilian Amazon (with Pablo Beramendi)

Policy reports

- Climate Related Game Changers: Enhancing Adaptation Program Impact to Address Climate Game Changers. Research Technical Assistance Center: Washington, DC. Briefing available here.(with Sarah Bermeo, Sarah W. Dickerson, & Paula J. Sarmiento)

Book chapters

- "O Programa Cisternas como Estratégia de Adaptação Climática (The Cistern Program as a Climate Adaptation Strategy)". in: Água para colher futuro: 20 anos do Programa Cisternas (2024) (*in press*).
- "Food security and nutrition and the human right to adequate food in Brazil: monitoring indicators and the constitution of 1988 to today" (2010). Conselho Nacional de Segurança Alimentar e Nutricional, Brasília, DF. 284 p.

Grants, Awards and Fellowships

- 2025-2026: von der Heyden Global Fellowship, competitive fellowship ($70,000)
- 2024-2026: Social impact assessment of FSC in Brazil, awarded by Center for International Forestry Research ($56,000)
- 2024: CLACS Research Travel Grant ($3,000)
- 2021-2023: Latin American and Caribbean Studies Fellowship Award, Duke University ($10,000)
- 2021-2022: Race and the Professions Fellowship - The Kenan Institute for Ethics at Duke University ($3,000)
- 2017-2018: Dean's Fellow for academic excellence, student leadership and community involvement
- 2016-2018: Global School of Policy and Strategy, University of California, San Diego - Fellowship Award ($28,500)
- 2005-2006: Coordination for the Improvement of Higher Education (CAPES) - Graduate Fellowship
- 2004-2005: Vocation for Diplomacy Award – Rio Branco Institute (Brazilian Diplomacy Academy), (R$25,000)
- 2002-2004: Special Training Program (fellowship granted by the Ministry of Education to high-performing Undergraduate Students)

Teaching

Teaching Assistant *Durham, NC, USA*
Duke University *2022-2024*

- Graduate-level courses: Statistics, Master's Project, and Evaluation of Public Expenditures.

Teaching Assistant *San Diego, CA, USA*
University of California, San Diego *2016-2018*

- Undergraduate courses: Introduction to Statistics, Power and Justice, Introduction to International Relations.
- Graduate courses: Globalization.

Lecturer *Brasilia, Brazil*
Centro Universitário do Distrito Federal (UDF) *Feb-July 2013*

- Public Policy Evaluation (Undergraduate course).

Lecturer *Brasilia, Brazil*
Getúlio Vargas Foundation (FGV) *Feb-July 2013*

- Planning and Budgeting for the MBA in Public Management.

National School of Public Administration (ENAP) *2008-2012*

- Professional courses in topics such as Brazilian State and Politics, Globalization, Public Administration and Development, and Ethics and Politics.

University of Brasilia *2006 & 2008*

- Introduction to Political Science.

Recent Presentations and Talks

Camp Resources *Asheville, NC, USA*
30th Camp Resources *Aug, 2025*

- Institutions, Incentives, and Identity: Understanding Deforestation Drivers in the Global South.

EAERE *Bergen, Norway*
30th Annual Conference of the European Association of Environmental and Resource Economists *Jun, 2025*

- Building Climate Resilience in the Global South: How a Decentralized Water Policy Alleviates Climate Shocks Impacts in Low-Income Communities.

LAERE *Bogota, Colombia*
First Congress of the Latin American and the Caribbean Association of Environmental and Resource Economists (LAERE) *March, 2025*

- Building Climate Resilience in the Global South: How a Decentralized Water Policy Alleviates Climate Shocks Impacts in Low-Income Communities.